LessonPlan Career Roadmap

Skills and Entrepreneurship (Skill Courses, Start-ups, Self-employment): Class 6 to Career

LESSONPLAN CAREER ROADMAP
Compiled from publicly available sources. Items marked † should be confirmed on the official notification of the conducting body. Dates and rules change every year.

1. Pathway overview

Stage	When	Key decision	What it unlocks
Foundation	Class 6-8	Build curiosity, money sense, communication and teamwork; try simple projects	Entrepreneurial and practical habits
Pre-board	Class 9-10	Try small projects, school fairs and digital skills; learn basic budgeting	Skill courses and start-up ideas
Stream choice	After Class 10	Any stream; combine school with a skill or vocational course	Skill certificates alongside Class 11-12
Skill training	After Class 10 / 12	Short-term skill courses (PMKVY / NSQF-aligned), ITI, vocational diplomas	Job-ready certificate
Start-up path	Class 11+	Idea, prototype, small sales, mentoring, incubator support	First venture or freelance work
Growth	Years later	Scale, funding, partnerships, formal degrees if needed	Business or professional career

2. Stage-by-stage nodes

Class 6-10: Foundation

- Decision: learn to save, budget and sell something small (school fair, craft, tutoring). Learn teamwork, communication and a digital skill (typing, spreadsheets, design, coding basics).
- School entrepreneurship or tinkering programmes (for example Atal Tinkering Labs and Startup India initiatives) may be available in some schools.†

After Class 10

- Combine Class 11-12 with a skill course in the evenings or holidays: digital marketing, coding, graphic design, accounting software, electrician or solar basics.
- Or move into ITI / vocational training (see Polytechnic and ITI document).

After Class 12

- Short-term certified training (PMKVY and NSQF-aligned courses), sector skill councils, vocational diplomas, apprenticeships.†
- Alongside a degree: internships, freelancing, small online or offline ventures.

Start-up and self-employment

- Steps: identify a problem, test with customers, build a minimum product, register the business, seek mentoring, loans or incubators.†
- Karnataka has a strong start-up ecosystem in Bengaluru; incubators and college entrepreneurship cells exist.†

3. Early preparation and school-level routes

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Exam / route	Conducted by	Classes	Details	Timing
School fairs, business-plan and innovation competitions	Schools, NGOs, banks	6-12	Teaches sales, budgeting and teamwork	Through the year
INSPIRE-MANAK	DST with NIF	6-12	School nominates up to 5 ideas; award 10,000 one-time	Check inspireawards-dst.gov.in†
NMMS (scholarship test)	Karnataka DSERT / KSEAB	8	Single written test	Apply Sep-Oct; exam Jan-Feb

Tip for parents: encourage small, safe projects with real customers (family and neighbours) and teach the basics of money. Check that any paid skill course is NSQF-aligned and the provider is approved.

4. Schemes and routes

PMKVY 4.0 (Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana) - Skill India	
Who	Indian youth including school and college dropouts and unemployed; age reported as 15-59 by third-party sources (15-45 in a NIELIT notice for its own courses)†
What	Short-term training aligned to NSQF with a certificate; some sources mention a completion bonus (about 8,000) not verified†
Status	One source says the scheme was extended to 31 December 2026; another says no fixed end date. Conflicting†
Rules	Attendance of at least 50% reported for NIELIT-run courses; biometric attendance†
Where	pmkvyofficial.in and the Skill India Digital portal†

ITI and apprenticeship	
Details	See the Polytechnic and ITI document: ITI trades, NCVT certificate and apprenticeship route†

Entrepreneurship support (national and Karnataka)	
Startup India / MUDRA / state schemes	Not confirmed at the time of compilation†
NIESBUD and entrepreneurship development programmes	Not confirmed at the time of compilation†
Karnataka Skill Development Corporation (KSDC)	Not confirmed at the time of compilation†

Other routes

Route	For	Key details
Sector Skill Councils (IT-ITeS, Retail, Healthcare, Automotive, Construction and others)	Industry-led certification	NSQF-aligned certificates; list and fees vary†
Online skill platforms (NPTEL, SWAYAM, Skill India Digital)	Free or low-cost certificates	Check recognition and employer acceptance†
College entrepreneurship cells and incubators	Degree students with business ideas	Mentoring, small grants and workshops†
Freelancing and online work (design, coding, content, tutoring)	Teens and young adults	Portfolio-based; no entrance exam

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Postgraduate and beyond (preview)

Exam	Body	For	Tentative timing
MBA / PGDM entrepreneurship and family-business tracks	IIMs and others	Management and venture roles	CAT / university tests†
CA / CS / CMA and professional accounting (for founders)	ICAI / ICSI / ICMAI	Finance and compliance	See Commerce document†

5. Scholarships and financial support

Scholarship	Provider	Who can apply	Amount	Window
Skill and entrepreneurship grants and loans (MUDRA, state schemes, incubator seed funds)	Government, banks, incubators	Applicants with business ideas	Varies	Per scheme†
NMMS	Govt. of India via Karnataka DSERT	Class 8 in govt/aided/local body schools; family income up to 3.5 lakh; at least 55% in Class 7 (50% SC/ST)†	12,000 per year (1,000 per month), Class 9-12	Apply Sep-Oct; exam Jan-Feb
CSSS (Central Sector Scheme)	Ministry of Education via National Scholarship Portal	Top 20% of successful candidates in own board and stream; family income up to 4.5 lakh	12,000 per year for UG years 1-3; 20,000 per year for years 4-5 / PG	2026-27 portal opened 1 Jun 2026; one listing shows 31 Oct 2026 deadline†
Post-matric scholarships	National Scholarship Portal and Karnataka SSP	SC/ST/OBC/minority categories, income limits	Varies	Typically Jul-Nov†

Note: always check scheme eligibility, interest and terms before borrowing for training or a business.†

6. Courses, training and institutions

Course / programme	Duration	Entry	Note
PMKVY / NSQF short-term courses	Weeks to months	Open enrolment†	Certificate on completion
ITI trades	6 mo - 2 yr	Class 8 / 10	See Polytechnic and ITI document
Vocational courses in school (NSQF subjects) and diplomas	Class 9-12 / 1-3 yr	Schools and polytechnics†	Skills alongside academics
Digital skills (coding, marketing, design, data)	Weeks to months	Open enrolment	Portfolio and freelance work
Entrepreneurship programmes and incubation	Months	Application or pitch	Mentoring and networks

Examples of institutions and platforms: ITIs and polytechnics, NSDC training partners, NIELIT centres, Skill India Digital portal, NPTEL / SWAYAM, college incubators and the Bengaluru start-up ecosystem.†

7. Career outcomes

Path	Job roles	Higher study / growth
Skilled trades and technicians	Electrician, solar installer, machine operator, mobile and appliance technician	Apprenticeship, advanced certificates
Digital and creative skills	Freelance designer, developer, marketer, video editor, data entry and analyst	Degree, certifications
Entrepreneur	Small-business owner, shop, workshop or service-company founder, start-up founder	Incubation, funding, MBA

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Path	Job roles	Higher study / growth
Self-employment in services	Tutor, caterer, salon, repair services, agri-business	Skill and enterprise loans

8. Related umbrellas this one connects to

- Polytechnic and ITI: formal technical routes (see Polytechnic and ITI document).
- Commerce: accounting, finance and business basics help every founder (see Commerce document).
- Design and Hospitality: design studios, cafes, events and travel ventures (see Design and Hospitality documents).
- Agriculture: agri-start-ups and farming (see Agriculture document).
- Sports and Arts: academies, coaching and creative businesses (see Sports and Arts document).

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ONE-PAGE GIST: Skills and Entrepreneurship

Items marked † are subject to confirmation against official notifications.

Stage	What to do
Class 6-10	Small projects, budgeting, digital skill, teamwork
After Class 10	Any stream + a skill course; or ITI / vocational training
After Class 12	PMKVY / NSQF short courses, apprenticeship, internships, freelancing
Start-up	Idea, test, small sales, mentor, incubator, registration
Growth	Funding, scale, degree or professional course as needed
Career	Technician, freelancer, entrepreneur, self-employed professional

Exam / route	When	Pattern / key point	Marking
PMKVY 4.0	Rolling batches†	Short-term NSQF-aligned training; age 15-59 reported	Certificate
ITI	After Class 8 / 10	NCVT trades; see Polytechnic and ITI document	Trade test (AITT)
INSPIRE-MANAK	Yearly nominations	Ideas Class 6-12; 10,000 award	Selection
Incubators / programmes	Application-based	Mentoring, grants, networks†	Pitch / selection

Key rules: skills pay best when certified and combined with real projects; check provider approval and scheme terms.†

Scholarships and support: NMMS (Class 8), CSSS (UG), skill and business loans.†

Careers: technician, freelancer, shop or workshop owner, start-up founder, self-employed professional.

Want a personalised roadmap or counselling? Contact LessonPlan, Yelahanka, Bangalore.

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